Hair-cutting day: run sheet

Сэвлэг үргээх найр · Boy · About 50 guests · At home · You are the father and the MC

Date: _____ Child's хий нас: _____ Start time from the lama: _____

How to use this sheet. The times are an example for a 10:00 start. If your lama gives a different time, move every time by the same amount. The rule from the traditions: **finish the hair cutting before noon.** The blue boxes are what you say as the MC. Fill in the blank names before the day.

Who does what

MC and feast leader	**You (the father)**
First cutter (ивээл жилтэй хүн)	_____
Collects the hair into the хадаг	Mother
Milk bowl and small cups	_____
Gift pouch and gift list	_____
Kitchen and serving	_____
Photos and video	_____
Looks after the guest children	_____
Short stand-in MC when you cut	_____
Blessing reciter / fiddle (ерөөлч, хуурч)	_____

Ritual tray (ready by 08:30)

- [ ] Scissors with a **blue хадаг** tied to the handle
- [ ] A small **wooden knife** (a wooden butter knife is fine)
- [ ] A bowl of **fresh milk** + about 60 small cups
- [ ] **Juniper (арц)** or incense (хүж) + something to burn it on
- [ ] A clean **хадаг or pouch for the hair**
- [ ] The child's **gift pouch** (хишгийн уут)
- [ ] Notebook and pen for the **gift list**
- [ ] **Electric clipper**, fully charged
- [ ] **Blessing tickets** in a bowl near the door
- [ ] First-cutter card (page 3 of the tickets)
- [ ] **Цагаалга** (rice cooked in milk, with аарц and raisins), made fresh
- [ ] Airag, milk tea, juice. **No vodka.**
- [ ] Thank-you gift for the first cutter; small gift bags for guest children

Rules almost every source agrees on

- Cut the hair **in the morning, before noon.** Traditionally, guests who come after noon do not cut; they join the meal.
- The first cut is at the **right temple** (for a boy).
- Lead the child **sunwise** (clockwise) around the room.
- **Keep all the hair**, also the clipper hair at the end. Never throw it away.
- **No vodka or hard alcohol.** Airag is fine.
- Food is cooked fresh on the day. No leftovers.
- If an important relative cannot come, **leave one lock uncut** for them.

The day, step by step

Example times for a 10:00 start. The cutting ends before noon.

07:00
90 min

Morning preparation

- Cook the цагаалга and the meal fresh. Set the table. Put the ritual tray near the head of the table.
- Charge the clipper. Put the blessing tickets in a bowl by the door.
- Give the child a light breakfast. A rested child is the most important thing today.

Who: **mother, kitchen helper, you**

08:30
20 min

Purify the scissors

- Burn the juniper or incense. Pass the scissors through the smoke.
- Tie the blue хадаг to the scissors handle.
- Optional, if your family does it: an incense offering (сан тавих) and sprinkling the first of the milk tea to the sky and land (цацал) outside.

Who: **you or a grandfather**

09:00
15 min

Brief the helpers, dress the child

- Tell each helper their job (page 1). Give the gift-list helper the cutting order (last page).
- If you hired an ерөөлч or a fiddle player, tell them the plan: when to play, how many tunes, when the long blessing comes.
- Dress the child in his deel.

Who: **you, mother**

09:30
30 min

Guests arrive

- Greet guests at the door. Seat the elders in the place of honour: at the back of the room, facing the door (хоймор). Seat the first cutter in the best seat.
- Serve milk tea. Ask quietly: "Ерөөл бэлдсэн үү?" Give a blessing ticket to anyone who did not prepare one.

Who: **you and mother at the door; a helper serves tea**

10:00
10 min

Opening: welcome and airag

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Эрхэм хүндэт аав ээж, ах дүү, анд нөхөд минь, сайхан өглөөний мэнд хүргэе!
>
> Өнөөдөр манай хүү _____ хий насаараа _____ хүрч, анхны сэвлэгээ үргээлгэх өлзий сайхан өдөр боллоо.
>
> Энэ өдрийг бидэнтэй хамт тэмдэглэхээр ирсэн та бүхэнд гэр бүлийнхээ өмнөөс талархал илэрхийлье.

- Offer the first bowl of airag to the oldest guest. Ask them for a short blessing.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Найраа эхлэхийн өмнө уламжлалынхаа дагуу айргийнхаа дээжийг өргөе.
>
> _____ ахаа (эгчээ), найрын ерөөлөө дэвшүүлж өгөхийг хүсье.

If you have a fiddle player: one tune here.

10:15
10 min

The first cut

- The child sits at the head of the table, then stands up for the cut.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Одоо найрын гол ёслол эхэлж байна.
>
> Хүүхэдтэй ивээл жилтэй, буян хишигтэй _____ ахаа (эгчээ), манай хүүгийн сэвлэгийг анх хөндөж, хайчны амыг нээж өгнө үү.
>
> **За одоо хүүгийнхээ даахийг үргээе!**

- The first cutter touches the hair with the **wooden knife**.
- Then cuts a small lock at the **right temple** with the хадаг scissors. Mother takes the lock into the хадаг.
- The child tastes milk from a cup. The first cutter dabs a little milk on the child's forehead.
- The first cutter says the blessing (first-cutter card) and gives the gift.

Who: **first cutter, mother, milk helper**

10:25
15 min

The family cuts

- Order: grandparents, then mother and you, then the father's side and the mother's side (авга, нагац), oldest first.
- When it is your turn, the stand-in MC says one line for you. Cut, say your blessing, and take the microphone back.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Одоо өвөө, эмээ нараа урьж байна. Хүүгийнхээ сэвлэгт гар хүргэнэ үү.
>
> Одоо авга, нагац ах дүү нараа урьж байна.

10:40
35 min

The guests cut

- Oldest guests first. Lead the child **sunwise** around the room, or let guests come to the child.
- Each guest: sips milk from a small cup, cuts a **tiny** lock, says a blessing, puts the gift in the pouch. The gift helper writes down who gave what.
- About 40 seconds per person. With about 40 guests, plan 35 minutes.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Хүндэт зочид маань ахмадаасаа эхлээд нар зөв дарааллаар сэвлэгт гар хүргэнэ үү.
>
> Сүүнээс амсаад, хадагтай хайчаар өчүүхэн хэсгийг хайчилж, ерөөлөө хэлээд, бэлгээ уутанд хийнэ үү.
>
> Ерөөл бэлдээгүй бол ширээн дээр ерөөлийн хуудас бий.

If the child is tired or cries: stop for 5 minutes. Let him sit on his mother's lap, give him a toy or a snack, then continue. Do not force him.

> **YOU SAY (ONLY IF YOU NEED A BREAK)**
>
> Манай хүү бага зэрэг амсхийе. Хэдэн минутын дараа үргэлжлүүлье.

11:15
10 min

The long blessing closes the ritual

- The ерөөлч or a respected elder says the long blessing, with music if you have a fiddle player. The cutting is now finished, before noon.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Сэвлэг үргээх ёслолоо ерөөлөөр өндөрлүүлье.
>
> _____ ах маань сэвлэг үргээх ерөөл дэвшүүлнэ.

11:30
60 min

The feast

- Serve **цагаалга** to everyone first, and a small bowl to each child. Then the meal.
- Airag for toasts. No vodka.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Хүүгийнхээ сэвлэгийг үргээж, та бүхний ерөөл хишгийг хүртлээ.
>
> Одоо цагаалгаа амсаж, найраа үргэлжлүүлье. Идээ ундаагаа сайхан хүртээрэй.

Who: **kitchen helper serves; you sit with the elders**

12:30
30 min

Songs, photos, play

- Songs at the table. Family photo with the child and the first cutter. Cake if you have one. The children play.

13:00
15 min

Finish the haircut (optional now)

- You shave or trim the rest of the hair with the clipper. Put **all** of the hair into the хадаг.
- If the child is tired, do it later at home or at a barber. Ask the barber to give you all the hair.

13:30
20 min

Thank-you gifts and closing speech

- Give the special gift to the first cutter. Give the small gift bags to the guest children.

> **YOU SAY**
>
> Өнөөдөр манай хүүгийн сэвлэг үргээх найрт ирж, ерөөл бэлгээ хайрласан та бүхэнд гүн талархал илэрхийлье.
>
> Хүүгийнхээ сэвлэгийг анх хөндсөн _____ ахдаа (эгчдээ) тусгайлан баярласнаа хэлье.
>
> Та бүхний ерөөсөн ерөөл биелж, бүгдээрээ эрүүл энх, сайн сайхан яваарай.

14:00
and after

Guests leave, and after

- See the elders to the door. If you wish, give them some of the food to take home.
- Fold the хадаг with all the hair and keep it in a safe place, like the family chest. Never throw it away.
- Keep the gift list. Call or message the elders and the first cutter the next day to thank them.

Cutting order

Write the names before the day. Give a copy to the stand-in MC and the gift-list helper.

First and family

1. First cutter: _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____

Elders and other guests

Oldest first. Guests not on this list cut after these.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____

Lock kept for an absent relative

Name: _____

If something goes wrong

- **The child cries or is tired:** pause, let him sit on his mother's lap, continue sitting down. Do not force him.
- **A guest comes after noon:** traditionally they do not cut the hair; they join the meal. Your family can decide.
- **The first cutter cannot come:** the oldest grandparent cuts first. If there is none, you (the father) cut first.
- **Not enough time:** let a married couple or a family cut one after another quickly, each with a short blessing.

Based on Mongolian sources and parents' experiences (2016–2026). Customs differ by family, region and lama. Your elders and your lama have the last word.